

PRO IN PROCRASTINATION
CD23731 - FILM MAKING AND RADIO PODCASTING

PROJECT REPORT

Submitted by

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RAJALAKSHMI ENGINEERING COLLEGE
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BONAFIDE CERTIFICATE

Certified that this Report titled “**PRO IN PROCRASTINATION**” is the bonafide work of **HARISH BABU R** (Register No. _____) who carried out the work under my supervision. Certified further that to the best of my knowledge the work reported herein does not form part of any other thesis or dissertation on the basis of which a degree or award was conferred on an earlier occasion on this or any other candidate.

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ANNEXURE III

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CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

1.1 About the Film

“Pro in Procrastination” is a short film that presents a familiar student problem: delaying an important responsibility while spending time on less important activities. The story follows Lakshanan, a student who receives a call from his friend Babu about a placement opportunity that requires registration before the deadline.

Instead of completing the registration, Lakshanan returns to watching reels on his phone. The screenplay then uses a fast-forward montage to show time passing while his attention remains on entertainment. Later, even after receiving an extension of the registration deadline, he continues postponing the task and eventually starts watching a movie.

The film focuses on the consequences of repeated delay. The story moves from a simple phone call about a placement opportunity to the final realization that the opportunity has been lost because the registration was never completed.

The screenplay is intentionally simple and uses a limited setting and a small number of characters so that the central idea of procrastination remains the main focus.

1.2 Background

The main purpose of the project is to communicate the effect of procrastination through a short, relatable student story. The screenplay begins with an ordinary situation and gradually shows how small delays accumulate until the available opportunity disappears.

The story is structured around the passage of time. Reels, sleeping, eating snacks, watching a movie, and repeated phone calls are used to show how Lakshanan spends the available time without completing the required registration.

1.2 Background

The screenplay provides practical filmmaking opportunities through a simple sequence of actions that can be visually represented without requiring complicated locations or a large cast. The main narrative elements include:

- Introducing a student in his room.
- Using a phone call to establish the placement opportunity and deadline.
- Showing procrastination through repeated entertainment activities.
- Using a montage to compress the passage of time.
- Using a second phone call to show that the deadline was extended.
- Showing the final realization that the registration was forgotten.
- Ending with a direct message about the effect of procrastination.

1.3 Theme and Message

The central theme of the film is **procrastination**. Lakshanan knows that the placement registration has to be completed, but he repeatedly chooses immediate entertainment over the task that requires attention.

The screenplay presents procrastination as more than simply wasting time. The final scene shows that the real consequence is the loss of an opportunity.

The message of the film is:

“PROCRASTINATION DOESN'T STEAL TIME. IT STEALS OPPORTUNITIES.”

This statement connects the events of the story with the broader lesson of taking action before an opportunity disappears.

CHAPTER 2

STORY & CHARACTERS

2.1 Story Synopsis

Lakshanan is sitting in his room watching reels when he receives a call from his friend Babu. Babu informs him that a company has arrived for placement and asks whether he has registered. Lakshanan has not registered. Babu tells him that the registration closes at 6:30 PM and asks him to complete it.

Lakshanan agrees, but after ending the call he immediately returns to watching reels. A montage shows the passage of time: he continues watching reels, the clock moves forward, he sleeps, wakes up, eats snacks, and returns to his phone.

Another call comes from Babu. Lakshanan learns that the registration deadline has been extended until 12:30 AM. He again says he will complete it, but the registration remains unfinished. At 11:00 PM, he chooses to watch a movie instead.

The movie continues while the clock moves from 11:00 PM to 1:30 AM. After the movie ends, Lakshanan goes to sleep. The next morning, Babu calls and asks whether he registered the previous day.

Lakshanan suddenly realizes that he forgot to register. The film ends with his regret and the message that procrastination can take away opportunities.

2.2 Main Characters

Name	Role in Story
Lakshanan	Main character; a student who repeatedly postpones the placement registration.
Babu	Friend of Lakshanan; informs him about the placement opportunity, deadline, and later the extension.

2.3 Character Development

Lakshanan's development is the main character progression in the film. At the beginning, he is relaxed and casually watching reels. Even after learning about the placement registration deadline, he does not treat the task as urgent.

When Babu later informs him that the deadline has been extended, Lakshanan receives another opportunity to act. However, he again postpones the registration and chooses entertainment. The next morning, his expression changes when he realizes that he completely forgot the task.

The character therefore moves from casual confidence to realization and regret. His change occurs only after the opportunity is no longer available.

2.4 Message

The film communicates that postponing an important task can create consequences that cannot always be reversed. Lakshanan is given more than one opportunity to register, but repeated delay prevents him from using the time available to him.

The message is especially connected to student life, where deadlines for placements, examinations, assignments, and applications can pass while attention is directed toward entertainment or other distractions.

2.5 Use of Time Progression

Time progression is one of the main storytelling techniques in the screenplay. Instead of describing every minute of Lakshanan's evening, the montage compresses several activities into a short sequence.

The clock is used to show the movement from the original deadline at 6:30 PM, to the extended deadline of 12:30 AM, and finally to 1:30 AM when the movie ends. This makes the passage of time visually important to the story.

The progression also creates tension because the audience can see that time is moving forward while the main task remains incomplete.

2.6 Symbolism of the Phone and Clock

The **phone** is the most important recurring object in the story. It has two contrasting functions. Babu's calls provide Lakshanan with useful information about the placement opportunity, while the same phone also provides the reels and movie that distract him from completing the registration.

The **clock** represents the limited nature of the available opportunity. The changing times show that the deadline is approaching and later that the deadline has already passed. Together, the phone and clock visually represent the conflict between distraction and responsibility.

2.7 Emotional Progression

Stage	Lakshanan's Emotional State
Beginning	Casual and relaxed
First call	Unconcerned but aware of the task
After the call	Comfortable and distracted
Second call	Still casual after receiving more time
Late night	Focused on entertainment rather than registration
Morning realization	Shock, regret, and frustration

This progression helps the audience understand that the final regret is the result of a series of earlier choices rather than a single unexpected event.

CHAPTER 3

PRE-PRODUCTION

3.1 Script Development

The screenplay was developed around the everyday problem of procrastination. The story begins with a simple placement-registration situation and builds toward the consequence of failing to act within the available time.

The screenplay uses a small number of characters and keeps the main action within Lakshanan's room. This supports a focused production and keeps the audience's attention on the character's behaviour and the passage of time.

The dialogue is written in a natural conversational style. Babu's phone calls provide the necessary information, while Lakshanan's short responses show his casual attitude toward the deadline.

3.2 Scene Planning

The screenplay can be divided into the following major stages:

- Lakshanan watches reels in his room.
- Babu calls and informs him about the placement registration.
- Lakshanan agrees to register but returns to watching reels.
- A montage shows time passing through multiple activities.
- Babu calls again and informs him about the extended deadline.
- Lakshanan continues postponing the registration and starts a movie.
- The clock moves from 11:00 PM to 1:30 AM.
- The next morning, Babu calls and Lakshanan realizes that he forgot.
- The film ends with the message about procrastination and lost opportunities.

This sequence provides a clear beginning, middle, and ending while maintaining the short-film format.

3.3 Locations

The screenplay identifies **Lakshanan's room** as the primary setting. The major actions—including watching reels, receiving calls, sleeping, eating snacks, watching a movie, and preparing for college—take place around this personal space.

Using one primary location keeps the story visually consistent and allows the focus to remain on the character and the movement of time.

3.4 Cast and Crew

The screenplay identifies two characters: Lakshanan and Babu. The screenplay does not specify the names of the actors or the individual production crew members. Therefore, the report records the roles without assigning unsupported names.

Role	Person/Character
Main character	Lakshanan
Friend / voice-call character	Babu
Writer	Not specified in the screenplay file
Director / Camera / Editor	Not specified in the screenplay file

3.5 Production Planning

The production planning is centered on continuity of the character's activities and the visible passage of time. The sequence of phone calls, clock changes, montage actions, movie duration, and morning realization must remain clear to the audience.

Particular attention is required for the timing of the montage and for showing the progression from evening to late night and then morning. The final phone call should clearly establish the consequence of the earlier delays.

CHAPTER 4

PRODUCTION

4.1 Shooting Process

The screenplay is structured so that the principal action can be captured around Lakshanan's room. The shooting process would need to cover the opening phone call, the repeated procrastination activities, the second call, the movie sequence, the sleep transition, and the morning scene.

The montage is especially important because several activities must communicate the passage of time quickly. Individual shots of reels, the clock, sleeping, eating snacks, and returning to the phone can be arranged to create a fast progression.

The screenplay does not specify the actual number of shooting days, takes, camera model, or production schedule, so these details are not assigned in this report.

4.2 Camera

The screenplay does not prescribe a particular camera or shot list. The visual structure nevertheless requires clear framing of Lakshanan, his phone, and the clock because these elements carry important story information.

Close or clearly visible shots of the phone can establish the incoming calls, while shots containing the clock can communicate the movement of time. The morning scene requires a clear view of Lakshanan's reaction when he realizes that the registration was forgotten.

The camera approach should support the simple and realistic nature of the story without distracting from the character's actions.

4.3 Lighting

The screenplay does not specify a lighting setup or equipment. From the story structure, the visual environment changes naturally from evening to late night and finally to morning. Maintaining a believable difference between these time periods would help the audience understand the progression.

Consistency is also important within the montage. The visual treatment of Lakshanan's room should remain coherent while the clock and activities communicate that time is passing.

4.4 Audio

Dialogue is an important part of the screenplay because Babu's phone calls provide the key information that drives the story. The calls establish the original 6:30 PM deadline, communicate the extension to 12:30 AM, and finally reveal that Lakshanan failed to register.

The phone ringing is also a useful recurring sound cue. The contrast between the call notifications and the quiet moments of watching reels or a movie can reinforce the conflict between responsibility and distraction.

4.5 Direction

Direction should focus on Lakshanan's gradual change in behaviour. His early performance is casual, because he does not feel immediate pressure. During the montage he remains comfortable even though time is passing. In the final morning scene, his expression changes suddenly when he realizes what he has forgotten.

The most important directing requirement is to make the final realization believable and clearly connected to the earlier decisions shown throughout the film.

CHAPTER 5

POST-PRODUCTION

5.1 Video Editing

The screenplay contains several editing instructions that define the intended rhythm of the film. It begins with **FADE IN**, uses a **MONTAGE – TIME PASSES** section to compress several activities, and later uses **CUT TO** for the transition to the morning scene.

The montage is central to the editing structure. It should quickly connect the individual activities—watching reels, the clock moving forward, sleeping, waking, eating snacks, and returning to the phone—so that the audience understands that a large amount of time has passed.

The screenplay also specifies the movement of the clock from 11:00 PM to 1:30 AM while Lakshanan watches a movie. This transition can be edited to make the passage of time clear without showing the entire movie.

5.2 Sound and Music

The screenplay specifically identifies phone ringing and spoken dialogue as important audio elements. Babu's voice is presented as **V.O.**, indicating that his dialogue is heard through the phone call while he is not physically present in the room.

The screenplay does not specify background music or particular sound-effect sources. Any additional music or effects used in the completed film should support the progression from casual entertainment to the final realization without changing the intended message.

5.3 Colour Correction

No specific colour-correction or grading process is described in the screenplay. The visual treatment can therefore be kept consistent across the evening, late-night, and morning portions so that the time progression remains understandable.

5.4 Titles and Final Presentation

The screenplay ends with a direct title-card style message after the scene cuts to black:

**“PROCRASTINATION DOESN'T STEAL TIME.
IT STEALS OPPORTUNITIES.”**

This final statement serves as the concluding message of the film. The screenplay then specifies **FADE OUT** followed by **THE END**.

The final presentation should preserve the clarity of this message. A clean transition to black followed by the statement allows the audience to connect the character's personal mistake with the wider theme of procrastination.

The screenplay does not specify the final credit design, font, music, or editing software, so those production-specific details are left open.

The post-production structure therefore depends mainly on timing, montage, transitions, dialogue clarity, and the final message rather than on complex visual effects.

CHAPTER 6

CONCLUSION

6.1 Final Outcome

“Pro in Procrastination” presents a simple student situation and turns it into a short narrative about the consequences of delaying important work. Lakshanan receives information about a placement opportunity and is given more than one chance to complete the registration, but he repeatedly chooses entertainment instead.

The final morning scene provides the consequence of those choices. When Babu asks whether the registration was completed, Lakshanan realizes that he forgot the task and that the opportunity has been lost.

The film's strength as a short narrative comes from its focused setting, small number of characters, repeated phone calls, montage, and clear final message.

6.2 Challenges Faced

Showing the passage of time: The story covers the period from evening to the next morning. The montage and clock references therefore need to make the passage of time easy to understand.

Making procrastination visually clear: The film must show that Lakshanan is actively choosing entertainment instead of simply forgetting the registration. The repeated return to reels and the decision to watch a movie communicate this behaviour.

Building the final realization: The morning scene has to connect clearly with everything shown earlier. The audience should understand that the missed opportunity is the direct result of the repeated delays.

Maintaining a short runtime: The screenplay contains several activities but presents them through a montage and selected scenes, allowing the story to remain concise.

6.3 Learning Outcomes

- Understanding how an everyday problem can be developed into a short-film story.
- Learning how dialogue can establish the central problem and deadline.
- Understanding how montage can compress a long period of time into a short sequence.
- Learning how recurring objects such as a phone and clock can support storytelling.
- Understanding the importance of continuity when showing changes in time.
- Learning how character behaviour can communicate a theme without lengthy explanation.
- Understanding how a final title-card message can reinforce the central idea.
- Recognizing the relationship between screenplay structure, scene transitions, sound cues, and audience understanding.

6.4 Overall Conclusion

The making of **“Pro in Procrastination”** demonstrates how a simple and relatable student experience can be transformed into a meaningful short-film narrative. The screenplay uses a small cast, a focused setting, phone conversations, a time-based montage, and a clear ending to communicate the consequences of postponing responsibility.

The story does not require a complicated plot to deliver its message. Instead, it builds the narrative through a sequence of ordinary decisions made by Lakshanan. Each delay appears small, but together they result in the loss of an important opportunity.

The final line, **“Procrastination doesn't steal time. It steals opportunities,”** summarizes the central lesson and gives the film a direct connection to real-life student experiences.

APPENDICES

Appendix A.1 – Screenplay Reference

The screenplay “**Pro in Procrastination – Short Film Screenplay**” is the primary narrative reference used for this report. It contains the scene description, dialogue, montage, transitions, final message, and ending of the film.

Appendix A.2 – Key Screenplay Elements

Element	Details
Title	Pro in Procrastination
Primary character	Lakshanan
Supporting character	Babu
Primary setting	Lakshanan's room
Main conflict	Procrastination of placement registration
Important time points	6:30 PM, 12:30 AM, 11:00 PM, 1:30 AM, next morning
Final message	Procrastination doesn't steal time. It steals opportunities.

Appendix A.3 – Production Details Not Specified in the Screenplay

The screenplay does not provide the final film's camera model, lighting equipment, editing software, shooting dates, actor names, or individual crew names. These details should be added later if they are required for the final institutional submission.